

Wednesday, 24 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Clear 36° 24°	BIRMINGHAM Mostly clear 33° 20°	MANCHESTER Clear 31° 20°	GLASGOW Overcast 23° 16°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The government is pressing ahead with its controversial defence spending plans, despite a recent high-profile resignation.

The proposals are set to be published before a Nato Summit in early July. This comes after a senior figure stepped down, reportedly over the plans.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Former SNP chief executive Peter Murrell has been jailed for over five years after admitting to embezzling party funds.

Mr Murrell, Nicola Sturgeon's husband, pleaded guilty to embezzling more than £400,000 over a 12-year period. The sentencing brings a significant chapter in the party's recent history to a close.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Around 29,000 lightning strikes lit up the skies across southern England as thunderstorms brought flash flooding and travel chaos.

The dramatic weather caused widespread disruption, with more extreme heat forecast for Tuesday. Many areas experienced significant rainfall in a short period.

WEATHER · UK
- 4

A major nursery chain, Bright Horizons, has been served with a safeguarding notice by Ofsted.

The regulator says the chain may not be meeting crucial safeguarding and welfare needs for children. This will be a concern for parents across the country.

EDUCATION · UK
- 5

A murder investigation has been launched after a body was found in the search for a missing 14-year-old girl, Lilly.

Lilly was reported missing on Saturday, sparking an urgent search. Police are now working to establish the circumstances surrounding her death.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Disney and Pixar are celebrating a record-breaking opening weekend for Toy Story 5!**
The film's huge success marks a significant return to form for the animation giants. It's a fantastic start for Woody, Buzz, and the gang's latest adventure.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Toy Story films? Which one is your favourite and why?
FILM · NOW
- 2 Johnny Marr, the legendary guitarist from The Smiths, is set to auction off a collection of his guitars.**
Among them are instruments he played with The Smiths and even with Billie Eilish. He says he's selling them to prevent his studio from becoming a museum!
ON AIR – If you could own a piece of music history, what instrument would you choose and from which artist?
MUSIC · SOON
- 3 Ozzy Osbourne's iconic concert throne is going on display for fans to see.**
The display coincides with the anniversary of his 'Back to the Beginning' concert on July 5th. It's a chance to see a piece of rock history up close.
ON AIR – What's the most unusual piece of music memorabilia you've ever seen or owned?
MUSIC · SOON
- 4 Former Scottish First Minister Nicola Sturgeon and Michael Gove are teaming up for a reality TV 'wargame'!**
They'll be taking part in a simulation of a Russian attack on the UK, with Sturgeon serving as deputy prime minister. It sounds like quite the dramatic watch!
ON AIR – Which political figures would you love to see in an unexpected reality TV scenario?
TV · SOON
- 5 Michael Fassbender says it's getting harder to trust what you see online these days.**
The star of the spy thriller 'The Agency' was discussing espionage, AI, and the personal cost of living a double life. It's a topic many of us can relate to.
ON AIR – Do you find yourself questioning what's real online more and more these days?
TV · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 Ipswich have appointed former Wolves and Bournemouth boss Gary O'Neil as their new manager on a three-year deal.**

O'Neil takes over from Kieran McKenna, who recently departed the club. Ipswich fans will be hoping he can build on their recent success.

ON AIR – What are your hopes for Ipswich under their new manager, Gary O'Neil?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 England's Red Roses stars could earn a huge £100,000 each if they successfully defend their Rugby World Cup title in 2029.**

The top players stand to benefit from a significant bonus should they triumph in Australia. It's a massive incentive for the team.

ON AIR – Is it right that female athletes are now earning such big bonuses for major tournament wins?

RUGBY · UK
- 3 Erling Haaland scored twice as Norway secured their place in the last 32 of the World Cup with a 3-2 victory over Senegal.**

It was a five-goal thriller in New Jersey, with Haaland once again proving to be the difference-maker. Norway will be thrilled to progress.

ON AIR – Is Erling Haaland the most impactful striker in world football right now?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP
- 4 Kylian Mbappe marked his 100th international cap with two goals as France beat Iraq 3-0 to sail into the knockouts.**

The match was delayed by a two-hour storm, but France weathered it to secure their place in the last 32. Mbappe continues to shine on the world stage.

ON AIR – How important is Kylian Mbappe to France's chances of winning the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP
- 5 Britain's Esther Adeshina is just two wins away from her Wimbledon dream after a huge career victory.**

She beat Japan's Moyuka Uchijima, marking the biggest win of her career so far. Adeshina is now within touching distance of a spot in the main draw.

ON AIR – Are you excited for Wimbledon to get underway, and who are you backing this year?

TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 2 More of us are taking up 'fake commutes' — a short walk before and after working from home.**
Psychologists say the made-up journey helps separate work from home life. Some people even pop to a shop and back to 'arrive'.
- 3 Charity shops are reporting a surge in both donations and shoppers as 'pre-loved' goes mainstream.**
Younger shoppers in particular are hunting for one-off finds. Volunteers say the most donated item by a mile is the unworn 'someday' outfit.
- 4 Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.
- 5 A study finds the average person has a 'comfort route' they walk or drive even when there's a faster way.**
Familiarity, not speed, wins. We'd rather the known road with the nice tree than save three minutes on the ring road.
- 6 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 7 Local 'repair cafés', where volunteers fix broken items for free, are spreading across the UK.**
Toasters, lamps and zips are the most common patients. Organisers say the biggest barrier is convincing people their old kettle is worth saving.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 48% of us do THIS every single day. What is it?
ANSWER: STEP ON THE BATHROOM SCALES.

Q 63% of us have done THIS in a meeting we're meant to be paying attention to. What?
ANSWER: ONLINE SHOPPING.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers say the smell of a particular food can transport you straight back decades.**
What smell instantly takes you back — and to exactly where?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Science.** Lightning strikes the Earth roughly 8 million times a day — about 100 times every second somewhere on the planet.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A weather station in the Lake District has had to relocate after its rain gauge kept overflowing so often that staff started using it to water the office plants.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.48 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The heart of a blue whale is so big a small child could theoretically crawl through its arteries.
- There are more public libraries than McDonald's restaurants in the UK.
- Goosebumps evolved to make our ancestors look bigger and to fluff up body hair for warmth.
- The Mona Lisa has no eyebrows.
- A 'baker's dozen' is 13 because medieval bakers added an extra loaf to avoid being fined for short measures.
- The fingerprints of a koala are so similar to a human's they could confuse a crime scene.
- The Eiffel Tower can be about 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in heat.
- Pineapples take around two years to grow a single fruit.

On this day

Day 175 of the year, 190 days left in 2026. Today Army Day or Battle of Carabobo Day (Venezuela); Bannockburn Day (Scotland); Christian feast day: Gohard; Christian feast day: Joseph Yuan. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Dennis Danell, American singer and guitarist (died 2000)
- 1942 — Arthur Brown, English rock singer-songwriter
- 1947 — Mick Fleetwood, English-American drummer
- 1966 — Adrienne Shelly, American actress, director, and screenwriter (died 2006)
- 1966 — Hope Sandoval, American singer-songwriter and musician
- 1978 — Ariel Pink, American singer-songwriter
- 1960 — Siedah Garrett, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1988 — Micah Richards, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1948 — Cold War: Start of the Berlin Blockade: The Soviet Union makes overland travel between West Germany and West Berlin impossible.
- 2021 — The Champlain Towers South condominium in Surfside, Florida suffers a sudden partial collapse, killing 98 people inside.
- 2010 — Julia Gillard assumes office as the first female Prime Minister of Australia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1939 — Siam is renamed Thailand by Plaek Phibunsongkhram, the country's third prime minister.
- 1947 — Kenneth Arnold makes the first widely reported UFO sighting near Mount Rainier, Washington.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1994 — A Boeing B-52 Stratofortress crashes at Fairchild Air Force Base near Spokane, Washington, killing four.
- 1981 — The Humber Bridge opens to traffic, connecting Yorkshire and Lincolnshire. It remained the world's longest bridge span for 17 years.

- 2010 — At Wimbledon, John Isner of the United States defeats Nicolas Mahut of France, in the longest match in professional tennis history.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 176 of the year, 189 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Philippines); Christian feast day: David of Munktorp; Christian feast day: Dorothea of Montau; Christian feast day: Eurosia. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Ricky Gervais, English comedian, actor, director, producer and singer
- 1958 — William Basinski, American musician and composer
- 1943 — Carly Simon, American singer-songwriter
- 1925 — June Lockhart, American actress (died 2025)
- 1974 — Nisha Ganatra, Canadian director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1940 — A. J. Quinnell, English-Maltese author (died 2005)
- 1979 — Busy Philipps, American actress
- 1940 — Mary Beth Peil, American actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2022 — Two people are killed and 21 more injured after a gunman opens fire at three sites in Oslo in a suspected Islamist anti-LGBTQ+ attack.
- 1976 — Missouri Governor Kit Bond issues an executive order rescinding the Extermination Order, formally apologizing on behalf of the state of Missouri for the suffering it had caused to members of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.
- 1993 — Kim Campbell is sworn in as the first female Prime Minister of Canada.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1996 — American rapper Jay-Z releases his debut album, Reasonable Doubt.
- 2007 — PMTair Flight 241 crashes in the Dâmrei Mountains in Kampot Province, Cambodia, killing all 22 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)